

Narratives in Design

NDes

Everyday objects around us carry meaning. Each object has its own story to tell, and you will bring your own perspective to it.

In this assignment, you will study an object of your choice and use storytelling to communicate its meaning. By applying narrative principles, structures and strategies, you will show how Design can connect with audiences with your ideas, interpretations and insights.

Objectives

This assignment aims to assess your ability to:

- Analyse the object's function, history, cultural significance, user experience, and visual semiotics.
- Communicate these insights clearly in a presentation.

Focus on what the object *already communicates* through its design, no redesign required.

Instructions

Select an everyday object that holds meaning to you. This can be, for example, a cup, a chair, a bag...etc.

Observe.

Analyse.

Communicate.

Explore and dive deep into its story.

Assignment 1
The Functional Object (30%)**Consider the following:**

- **Function:** How does the object serve its purpose?
- **User:** Who uses it, and how does it fit into their life?
- **History & Culture:** Where does the object come from? How has it evolved?
- **Emotional or Symbolic Significance:** What feelings, memories, or stories are attached to it?

In a narrative presentation deck, do the following:

Write an Introduction

- Name and show the object. Use original photograph or illustration.
- Explain why you selected it: Function, user, history, cultural, emotional and/or symbolic significance...etc

Document Observations & Analysis

- Research and examine key aspects such as shape, material, texture, colour, proportions, and other design features that influences function.
- User Persona: How would a user interact or respond to this object? Use 'Rules of Three' storyboarding method.
- Describe the visual semiotics on how these elements shape and convey emotions and meaning.

Deliver a Presentation

- Present your findings (5mins) focusing on how narratives in design contribute to the story of the chosen object.

Deliverables

- A narrative presentation deck (8-10 pages) in .PDF.

Assignment 1
The Functional Object (30%)

Criteria	Narrative Interpretation & Depth of Analysis (40%) — The ability to provide a strong perspective and depth behind the story of the chosen functional object using narrative principles and storytelling elements. Storytelling Methods (40%) — The effective use narrative tools and strategies. Including, but not limited to, persona, storyboard, and visual semiotics. Presentation (20%) — The clear and coherent narrative in the communication of the findings. DES AIAS: No AI Allowed in all components of this assignment
Requirements	Upload your digital submission under ASSESSMENT on Brightspace LMS. Your digital submission must consist of the following: • Narrative Presentation Deck (8-10 pages) in .PDF. File naming convention: NDes_TD01_2612345_Your Full Name_Assignment01.pdf
Deadline	The assignment is due to be submitted on Brightspace LMS <u>before the start of Lesson 8</u>. Students will present Assignment 1 during lesson 8.